

Comparing Three-Digit Numbers

Answer Key

Grade 2–3 Mathematics

Quick Answers

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|----------------|------------------|------------------|
| 1. — | 5. 437, 473, 743 | 9. 650, 605, 560 |
| 2. 352, 328, — | 6. 209, 198, — | 10. 557, —, — |
| 3. — | 7. — | |
| 4. — | 8. — | |
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Curriculum

Level: Grade 2–3 Mathematics

2.NBT.A – *problems 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10*

Difficulty 1–5 of 5 across 16 tagged checks.

Common wrong answers

6. *If they got 29: skipped the empty tens place and wrote the hundreds digit next to the ones digit*

1. Red bin 462 books, blue bin 429 books.

Chart both numbers, then read from the left.

Hundreds: 4 and 4 — the same, so the hundreds place decides nothing.

Tens: 6 and 2. Six tens is more than two tens, so the red bin wins here and the ones digits never have to be looked at.

$$\boxed{462 > 429}$$

2. Ella: 3 flats, 5 rods, 2 cubes. Ryan: 3 flats, 2 rods, 8 cubes.

Each flat is one hundred, each rod is one ten, each cube is one.

Ella: $3 \times 100 + 5 \times 10 + 2 = 300 + 50 + 2$, so $\boxed{352}$

Ryan: $3 \times 100 + 2 \times 10 + 8 = 300 + 20 + 8$, so $\boxed{328}$

Same hundreds (3 each), so compare tens: 5 rods beats 2 rods.

$$\boxed{352 > 328}$$

Grading note: Ryan has more cubes, so a student who compares ones first will pick Ryan. Comparing always starts at the left.

3. Compare 508 and 580.

Hundreds: 5 and 5 — tied.

Tens: 0 and 8. Zero tens is fewer than eight tens, so 508 is the smaller number. The **tens place** is the place that decides this pair.

$$508 < 580$$

Grading note: the 0 is not "nothing there" — it holds the tens place open so the 8 stays in the ones place.

4. Oak 615 cans, Pine 651 cans.

Hundreds: 6 and 6 — tied. Tens: 1 and 5, so Pine has more tens.

$$615 < 651$$

Pine School collected more cans.

5. Order 473, 437, 743 from least to greatest.

Compare hundreds first: 4, 4, and 7. The 7 hundreds is the biggest, so 743 goes last no matter what.

The two numbers with 4 hundreds are separated by their tens: 7 tens against 3 tens, so 437 comes before 473.

$$437, 473, 743$$

6. Sam: 2 flats, 0 rods, 9 cubes. Nina: 1 flat, 9 rods, 8 cubes.

Sam: $2 \times 100 + 0 \times 10 + 9 = 200 + 0 + 9$, so $\boxed{209}$

Nina: $1 \times 100 + 9 \times 10 + 8 = 100 + 90 + 8$, so $\boxed{198}$

Nina really does have more rods, but rods are only tens. Sam has 2 hundreds against Nina's 1 hundred, and hundreds are compared first, so Sam's number is greater.

$$209 > 198$$

Grading note: 29 means the empty tens place was skipped when writing Sam's number — the 0 has to be written so the 9 stays in the ones place.

7. Compare 384 and 389.

Hundreds tie at 3. Tens tie at 8. So the ones place is the only place left, and 4 is less than 9.

$$384 < 389$$

8. Maya 892 steps, Ben 928 steps.

Maya is looking at the wrong place. Comparing starts at the hundreds: 8 hundreds against 9 hundreds. Ben has more hundreds, so Ben's number is greater and the tens digits are never needed.

$$892 < 928$$

Ben walked more steps. Maya is not right.

9. Order 605, 650, 560 from greatest to least.

Hundreds: 6, 6, and 5. The number with 5 hundreds, 560, is the smallest, so it goes last.

The two numbers with 6 hundreds split on their tens: 0 tens against 5 tens, so 650 is greater than 605.

$$650, 605, 560$$

10. Challenge: 5 hundreds, missing tens, 7 ones.

Try the tens digits in order. The hundreds and ones already match 547, so the tens digit is what settles both tests.

A tens digit of 4 gives 547, which is equal to 547 and not greater than it. The next digit up is 5, giving $\boxed{557}$

Check the first test — same hundreds, and 5 tens beats 4 tens:

$$\boxed{557 > 547}$$

Check the second test — same hundreds, and 5 tens is fewer than 8 tens:

$$\boxed{557 < 587}$$

So the smallest number that passes both tests is 557; any tens digit from 5 to 7 works, but 5 is the smallest of them.